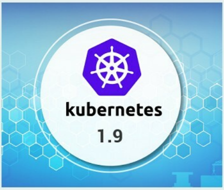
Windows gets Kubernetes 1.9 beta support

The arrival of Kubernetes 1.9 is nicely timed as it has become part of the cloud container orchestration programme. The container management programme is available on all serious cloud platforms since Amazon Web Services (AWS) adopted Kubernetes.



Kubernetes was originally developed for Linux systems, but there's been a demand for Kubernetes to run Windows workloads as well. This is in addition to making Kubernetes available for Linux on Azure.

In October 2017, Microsoft announced a dedicated Azure Container Service for Kubernetes. Running Windows apps on Docker on Windows Server, while managing them with Kubernetes, is now in beta. Apps Workloads' application programming interface (API) is now stable and available for general use.

The two most commonly used Deployment and ReplicaSet form the foundation for long-running Kubernetes stateless workloads, and are stable now.

From its start, Kubernetes has supported multiple options for persistent data storage, including commonly used NFS or iSCSI. Kubernetes developers are addressing this by adopting Container Storage Interface (CSI). Kubernetes 1.9 is available for download on GitHub.

Red Hat OpenShift Application Runtimes empowers cloud-native development

Red Hat has announced the general availability of Red Hat OpenShift Application Runtimes. The announcement aims to enable organisations to accelerate cloud-native app development with a curated set of frameworks and runtimes for prescriptively building and running microservices-based applications.

Red Hat OpenShift Application Runtimes leverages the company's decade-plus of experience with Red Hat JBoss Middleware to build from the ground up a solution for the next generation of microservices-based application development. Red Hat aims to balance the developers' need for choice with the operational requirement for standardisation and support.

It provides a tightly integrated and fully supported offering for developing microservices in multiple languages and frameworks. Certified and supported runtimes available with Red Hat OpenShift Application Runtimes include Java EE, WildFly Swarm, Eclipse MicroProfile, Eclipse Vert.x, Node.js and Spring Boot.

The key features and benefits include simplified development and strategic flexibility. Combined with the OpenShift service catalogue, enterprise IT organisations can take full advantage of multi-cloud investments by integrating cloud based services. Due to the integration of Red Hat OpenShift Container Platform with Red Hat OpenShift Application Runtimes, developers get access to a fully automated platform for provisioning, building and deploying applications and their components.

Dgraph raises US$ 3 million for its open source distributed graph database

Dgraph, an increasingly popular open source distributed graph database that uses a version of Facebook's GraphQL as its default query language, has released version 1.0.

Dgraph has announced that it has raised US$ 3 million in funding from Bain Capital Ventures, Atlassian co-founder Mike Cannon-Brookes, Blackbird Ventures and AirTree (this includes a US$ 1.1 million seed round the company raised last year). The company also announced that its flagship open source distributed graph database has hit the version 1.0 stage.

Dgraph founder Manish Jain shared that finding funding for this project wasn't easy, but a chance meeting got him in front of Bain, which had already been pitched by competing companies. It also didn't help that Jain was living in Australia at the time and that he founded the company there. Now, with a green card in hand, he's moving himself and the company to the US.

The company believes that Dgraph's edge over competitors like Neo4 and others is the fact that it was built as a distributed database from the ground up.

The Dgraph project started in late 2015, and even though it didn't hit version 1.0 until now, it's already being used in production by quite a few developers. Current users include gaming services, as well as advertising and financial technology companies that, among other things, use it as part of their fraud detection platforms. Other use cases include the likes of search engines, IoT, medical research, machine learning and AI.

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